

Cleaning up

Don’t forget to clean up your AWS account before proceeding with the next step, as shown here:

```
$ aws cloudformation delete-stack --stack-name etherpad-packer
```

15.3.1 Tips and tricks for Packer and CloudFormation

Finally, we want to share the following tips and tricks for deploying an application of your choice with the help of Packer and CloudFormation:

- Launch an EC2 instance based on Amazon Linux 2 or the distribution you want to build on.
- Go through the steps necessary to get the application up and running manually.
- Transfer the manual steps into a shell script.
- Create a Packer template, and include the shell script.
- Run `packer build`, and launch an instance based on the AMI for testing.
- Roll out the AMI with CloudFormation and an Auto Scaling group.
- Use a user data script for dynamic configuration, as shown in our example.